

Appendix for White House News Collection (1968-2025)

A.1. Data: Contract Solicitations and Requests for Information

In the paper, I repeatedly refer to four sets of contract documents. Below, I provide more details about how to locate each of the key documents.

- **2001 draft proposal:** see the Draft Proposal For White House News Summary and Clips Package, which is attached to an email from Paul Roellig to Vickers B. Meadows on February 16, 2001 (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).
- **2010 SOW:** see the section entitled “SECTION C: DESCRIPTION/SPECIFICATIONS/ STATEMENT OF Objectives” from the 2010 Request for Proposals for “Daily News Summary/News Clips” posted Sep 01, 2010, Notice ID OAS-GEN-R-10-0101.
- **2018 SOW:** see the Solicitation for “Expert-edited Daily and Intra-day News Briefings” posted Sept. 14, 2018, Notice ID OND-GEN-D-18-0052.
- **2021 SOW:** see the “Statement of Work News Briefing Services” document attached to the 2021 Request for Quotation for “News briefings summaries, news clips, or full texts of the articles or transcripts summaries” posted on Jul 14, 2021, Notice ID 11316021Q0005EOP.

Table A1: Relevant Executive Office of the President (EOP) Contract Solicitations

Year	Title of Contract Opportunity	Notice ID
2005	NEWS SUMMARY AND NEWS CLIP SERVICES	EOPOA-25010
2006	News Summary and News Clip Services	OVP-S-06-001
2010	Daily News Summary/News Clips	OAS-GEN-R-10-0101
2010	News Summaries and News Clips	WHO-GEN-R-10-0009
2016	Daily Expert-Edited News Briefings	EOP-NC-2016
2018	Expert-edited Daily and Intra-day News Briefings	OND-GEN-D-18-0052
2021	News briefings summaries, news clips, or full texts of the articles or transcripts summaries	11316021Q0005EOP

Table A1 lists all relevant contract opportunities that I identified on sam.gov, which is the official U.S. government system for contracting. Some of these listings have the original contract

documents, including a Statement of Work (SOW). Older listings tend to have less information.

A.2. Data: WHNS and WHNC

A.2.1. Bill Clinton, George W. Bush, and Barack Obama

Bulletin produces two documents every day: a narrative summary of the news (White House News Summary, “WHNS”) and a packet of full text news articles used to construct the news summary (White House News Clips, “WHNC”). Unfortunately, not all of the news reports are freely available from the presidential libraries and VP archives. Before these documents can be accessed, a researcher must submit a Freedom of Information Act Request (FOIA) to the relevant presidential library or archive. I submitted FOIA requests for all of the Clinton documents, but due to the cost of scanning, I cannot afford to have all of them scanned. For Bush and Obama, I requested a randomly sampled set of dates (stratified by quarter). Due to long queues at the libraries, I also submitted requests to the Cheney and Biden Vice Presidential Records at the National Archives. As of June 2025, I have copies of 319 WHNC and 126 WHNS from the Bush administration as well as 1 WHNC and 79 WHNS from the Obama administration.

Clinton – Due to previous FOIA requests, many clipbooks from 1993-1996 were already available and digitized. In total, I found 236 WHNC and XXX WHNS from 1993 to 1996. In May 2024, I requested all digital copies of WHNS from the Clinton Presidential Library (FOIA 2024-0621-F). According to a June 12, 2024 email from Dana Simmons, library staff were only able to identify emailed copies of the White House News Reports between 1993-1994. They were also unaware of the electronic “bulletin board” described by Ken Chitester. It is possible that those records were not properly preserved. In May 2024, I also requested all paper records from the Records of the Office of the Press Secretary from the Clinton Presidential Library (FOIA 2024-0592-F and 2024-0593-F).¹ I requested all documents in the series “White House News Reports, 1993–2001”² and “White House News Reports emails sent by News Analysis Staff 1993-1994.”³ As of November

¹ See <https://catalog.archives.gov/id/2525058>.

² See <https://catalog.archives.gov/id/7432014>.

³ See <https://catalog.archives.gov/id/7432027>.

2025, both archives are fully available to the public. However, because the records are on paper, they need to be scanned. I have partially digitized the tables of contents from News Clips from 1996-1999.

Bush — Previous FOIA requests contained 237 WHNC and 39 WHNS (see FOIA 2014-0157-F, 2015-0138-F, 2016-0370-F, 2018-0102-F, and 2021-0121-F). From June to October 2024, I requested emailed copies of both documents for a random sample of additional dates (FOIA 2024-0195-F, 2024-0196-F, 2025-0014-F, 2025-0013-F).

Obama — Previous FOIA requests only contained 1 WHNC and 2 WHNS (see FOIA 22-17618-F and 22-17767-F). In October 2024, I requested emailed copies of both documents. According to a September 20, 2024 call with the Obama library, news clips were not emailed after 2010 but news summaries were emailed throughout the Obama administration. To expedite processing of the FOIA requests, I randomly sampled the dates and requested them in batches of approximately 100 documents (FOIA 24-43837-F, 24-46676-F, 24-70036-F, 24-70037-F, 24-70038-F, 24-70039-F). As of June 2026, none of these records have been released. However, the first two batches (FOIA 24-43837-F and 24-46676-F) should be released around September 2026.

VP Archives — In September 2024, I requested random samples and the largest email containing news reports from the Cheney and Biden Vice Presidential Records at the National Archives (FOIA 2025-0058-F, 2025-0059-F, 2024-0130-F, 2024-0131-F, 2024-0132-F, 2024-0133-F). According to a September 25, 2024 email from Jessica Owens at the National Archive, they could not find any copies of WHNC or WHNS emailed to the Office of the Vice President (OVP) staff members before 2005. They also noted that they could not locate some requested dates in mid to late 2008. In the Biden-era OVP emails, they found no copies of the WHNC from October 1, 2010, until the end of the administration. They found copies of the requested WHNS for all but 3 of the requested 80 dates. As of January 2026, all but one of these requests has been publicly released.

A.2.2. Ronald Reagan's news summaries

Recently, copies of select news summaries from June 1984 to August 1987 were digitized and posted by the Reagan presidential library. See the Ronald Reagan Presidential Library's col-

lected titled “News Summary Office, White House: News Summaries, 1981-1989.” The files are available on this web page: <https://www.reaganlibrary.gov/research/finding-aids/news-summary-office-white-house-news-summaries-1981-1989>.

I reviewed 15 news summaries from Reagan Presidential Library’s collection: June 1, 1984; August 27, 1984; October 18, 1984; November 14, 1984; July 10, 1985; July 24, 1985; November 6, 1985; January 10, 1986; May 9, 1986; August 13, 1986; October 29, 1986; December 17, 1986; May 4, 1987; April 22, 1987; and July 7, 1987.

Only five of these news summaries contained “Foreign Media Reaction” sections (November 6, 1985; January 10, 1986; May 9, 1986; December 17, 1986; April 22, 1987). All but one example had only one page of foreign press clips, and the only exception (November 6, 1985) had two pages of foreign press clips.

Sometimes, there would also be an additional page or two of editorials from a wider selection of local and national papers. Eight of the fifteen news summaries that I reviewed had a one to two page section with local and national editorials (October 18, 1984; July 10, 1985; November 6, 1985; January 10, 1986; May 9, 1986; December 17, 1986; April 22, 1987; July 7, 1987). In each case, local clips were limited to editorials sections at the end of the summary.

A.3. Local papers requested by George W. Bush’s administration in February 2001

In email from February 2001, the Bush White House asks Bulletin to create a proposal for creating a separate local news report with additional local papers. See the February 2, 2001 08:57:30 email from Brian Bravo to Mark Gabor (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

Also our office of Media Affairs wants to know the possibility of you guys doing a separate [sic] project of regional newspaper stories. This would not be included in the original clips, but done a little later. I do not know if this is possible or what the billing logistics and service requirements are, but I said I would ask. Please let me know if possible. They have a list of cities they want checked, so anyway let me know.

Bulletin responded with a proposal on February 7th. See proposal attached to the February 7,

2001 16:14:01 email from Paul Roellig to William T. Griffin (Bush Library FOIA 2024-0154-F).

Due to the inconsistent times the daily news is posted on the Web sites of a number of the local papers selected by the White House, it is difficult to accurately state what BNN can do and at what cost. The attached page shows the approximate times the White House-selected newspaper Web sites were updated today.

BNN has developed special relationships with a number of media companies and their reporters, however, which allows BNN to acquire by email and fax the relevant news stories before they are posted on the newspapers' Web sites. BNN would attempt to develop such relationships with the White House-selected newspapers, but cannot guarantee success.

BNN proposes to produce a separate news clips package for the White House based on the local newspapers selected by the White House. The length of such a package will vary day-to-day, and may increase in size as possible special relationships are developed with the late-posting newspapers. BNN proposes to deliver this additional local newspaper clips package to the White House by 9:30 a.m. each morning.

Table A2 contains the list of local newspapers attached to the proposal in a section called "Target News Sites for Monitoring."

Table A2: Target News Sites for Monitoring from Bulletin's 2001 Local News Proposal

State	Paper Name	News Updated
Arkansas	Arkansas Democrat-Gazette (Little Rock) Southwest Times Record (Ft. Smith)	Up by 5:00 a.m. Not up by 10:00 a.m.
Florida	Tampa Tribune St. Petersburg Times Orlando Sentinel Miami Herald	Up by 5:00 a.m. Up by 5:00 a.m. Up by 2:30 a.m. Up by 8:00 a.m.
Iowa	Des Moines Register Cedar Rapids Gazette Waterloo-Cedar Falls Courier	Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m. Not up by 10:00 a.m.
Maine	Portland Press-Herald & Maine Sunday Telegram Bangor News	Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 10:00 a.m.
Michigan	Detroit Free Press Detroit News Grand Rapids Press Kalamazoo Gazette Flint Journal Saginaw News Bay City Times	Up by 5:00 a.m. Up by 5:00 a.m. Not up by 10:00 a.m. Some, but not most, up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 9:15 a.m.
Minnesota	Minneapolis Star-Tribune Minneapolis Pioneer Press	Up by 2:30 a.m. Up by 2:30 a.m.
Missouri	St. Louis Post-Dispatch Kansas City Star Springfield News-Leader	Up by 2:30 a.m. Up by 2:30 a.m. Up by 5:00 a.m.
Nevada	Las Vegas Review-Journal Las Vegas Sun	Up by 5:00 a.m. Not up by 10:00 a.m.
New Hampshire	Manchester Union Leader	Up by 2:30 a.m.
New Mexico	Albuquerque Journal Albuquerque Tribune	Up by 9:30 a.m. Not up by 9:45 a.m.
Ohio	Cleveland Plain Dealer Cincinnati Enquirer Cincinnati Post Columbus Dispatch Dayton News	Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 2:30 a.m. Up by 9:30 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 2:30 a.m.
Oregon	Portland Oregonian Eugene Register-Guard	Not up by 9:45 a.m. Not up by 9:50 a.m.
Pennsylvania	Philadelphia Inquirer Philadelphia News Pittsburgh Post-Gazette Pittsburgh Tribune-Review Wilkes-Barre Citizen's Voice Wilkes-Barre Times Leader Scranton Times and Tribune	Up by 5:00 a.m. Up by 5:00 a.m. Up by 5:00 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m.
Tennessee	Nashville Tennessean Memphis Commercial Appeal Knoxville News-Sentinel	Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 5:00 a.m. Up by 5:00 a.m.
West Virginia	Charleston Gazette Charleston Mail Clarksburg Exponent and Telegram Bluefield Telegraph	Up by 5:00 a.m. Not up by 9:50 a.m. Not up by 9:55 a.m. Up by 9:50 a.m.
Wisconsin	Milwaukee Journal Sentinel Green Bay News-Chronicle Green Bay Press-Gazette Madison Capitol Times & Wisconsin State Journal	Up by 2:30 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m. Up by 5:00 a.m. Up by 8:30 a.m.